

BEST OF COMPUTEX 2018

The Mecca of PC components had several incredible products on showcase this year. Here's our pick of the best ones.



ASUS Project Precog

One screen on a laptop is normal. How about two screens? ASUS showcased the Project Precog, a laptop where the keyboard is replaced with a screen. Essentially, you're getting a foldable device with two touchscreens. The product is targeted for a different segment of users who prefer multi-tasking and extra screen real estate. With artificial intelligence built inside the laptop, it will be able to determine whenever there's a keyboard plugged in. The second screen will throw up a virtual keyboard but when a physical keyboard is connected, it will disappear. A similar switching will happen to the virtual trackpad if a mouse is connected. It can detect the orientation of the device, so if it's folded and placed on the edges, the display will switch to a Book mode. There's also a Flat mode where the laptop opens up to 180 degrees, to be used by two people on each side for some PvP gaming. The Tent mode will allow two users sitting across each other to look at the screens over a meeting, acting as a brilliant productivity device. ASUS didn't reveal the price but they do actually plan on making this into a commercial product by next year.

Qualcomm Snapdragon 850

Qualcomm announced the Snapdragon 850 with the aim of powering low power Windows 10 machines for an always on, always connected use case. This platform brings together an X20 LTE Modem coupled with Qualcomm Wi-Fi solutions for the connectivity aspect. There's also the Qualcomm Hexagon 685 Vector processor to aid the Qualcomm Kryo CPU. On the GPU front, the 850 is powered by a Qualcomm Adreno 630 Visual Processing System. Additionally, it also houses the Qualcomm Spectra 280 ISP and Aqstic Audio Technologies. The key upgrades in the 850 over the Snapdragon 835 come down to the better Kryo 385 CPU which can now go up to 2.95 GHz, faster Gigabit speeds which now have an increased cap of 1.2 Gbps and a more optimised power profile that allows for multi-day battery life just like smartphones. The 850 platform has five key pillars which include the always on and always connected capability, powerful AI compute power, entertainment capabilities and support for Windows 10.

